

Microsoft TrackBall Optical

Features: Optical track ball, USB interface, two extra buttons
Price: Rs 1,690 Contact: Microsoft Corporation India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 011-26292640 E-mail: connect@microsoft.com
Web site: www.microsoft.com

Trackball devices have always generated a negative response from first time users, since they require patience and some getting used to. The trackball device is designed for comfort and to reduce the possibility of acquiring Repetitive Strain Injury (RSI). Unlike finger-driven trackballs, which require the thumb to click and hold the pointer device's buttons, the Optical's design allows you to use your forefinger and the middle finger to operate the buttons and the scroll-wheel, thus mimicking the way we use a mouse. Although the device looks daunting, it does not take up too much desk space.

The installation is hassle-free and the software included, Intellimouse 4.1, lets you configure the extra buttons. Its Optical nature offers a highly accurate, slip-free method of pointing, even when the ball is rolled rapidly. It is a USB device but comes with a PS2 adapter. Exclusively designed for right-handers, the Optical leaves lefties completely at a loss.



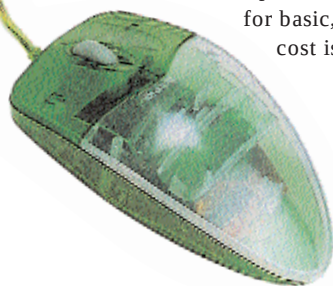
Trackball Optical B-	
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Build quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Ergonomics	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶

Odyssey Web Scroll Mouse

Features: PS/2 interface, no extra buttons Price: Rs 293
Contact: Compuage Infocom Ltd Phone: 022-23842200
E-mail: info@compuageindia.com
Web site: www.compuageindia.com

The first thing that strikes you about the Odyssey Web Scroll mouse is its transparent goblin green body, complete with a matching transparent green cable. The device is a standard three-button scroll mouse, designed for both right and left-handed users. Featuring a PS/2 interface, the Web Scroller is a little too large for comfort for those with small hands. Additionally, the pointed tip of the device digs into the bottom of the palm, making it uncomfortable during long hours. The buttons, though large, seem tacky and do not have a comfortably snug feel about them. The scroll wheel also fails to deliver accuracy and tends to scroll a little more or less than is desired. Apart from this, the device is smooth and offers decent precision. The package includes IWare Plus for Windows 95/98/NT on a floppy disk.

With a price tag of Rs 200, the device is suitable for basic, non-frequent home usage where cost is a consideration.



Odyssey Web Scroll B	
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Build quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Ergonomics	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶

Microsoft Wireless IntelliMouse Explorer

Features: Optical mouse, USB interface, two extra buttons, two AA batteries Price: Rs 3,380 Contact: Microsoft Corporation India Pvt Ltd Phone: 011-26292640 E-mail: connect@microsoft.com
Web site: www.microsoft.com

The Intellimouse fits perfectly within the palm, making long working hours easy on the hand. The black and metallic grey combination makes it an attractive piece. The buttons are easy to click with the two extra buttons just under the thumb for faster access. The mouse is good for both gaming as well as regular office sessions. The accuracy afforded by the optics ease both, railing opponents in *Quake III Arena* and making pixel-precise selections in Adobe Photoshop. The scroll button, which doubles as the middle button, is very smooth and noiseless. The pack came with two AA batteries, a receiver, a software CD and a manual. The mouse gets detected without a hassle or a need to provide drivers. This optical mouse is a worthy upgrade from the previous corded optical or the cordless infrared mouse.



IntelliMouse Explorer A-	
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Build quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Ergonomics	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶

Samsung SMP2100WX

Features: PS/2 interface, no extra buttons Price: Rs 260
Contact: Samsung Asia Pte Ltd Phone: 022-22814886

Samsung is trying to break the price barrier in the mouse market with the introduction of the SMP 2100WX, a standard two-button scroll mouse, available for the PS/2 interface. It performs just as expected for a price of Rs 260. Being a Plug and Play device, all versions of Windows can immediately detect and configure the mouse as well as the associated scroll wheel. Since it has only two buttons, there's nothing programmable here. Everything sets up instantly.

As far as the feel of the SMP2100WX is concerned, the wheel is slightly unbalanced and tends to jerk up and down. Discouragingly, the rest of the mouse feels just as unstable and at high speeds, it tends to move towards the left and the bottom. This unbalance makes it difficult to use the SMP2100WX for fast-paced games such as *Quake III Arena*. If you intend to use it for everyday office applications and play games once in a while, then this mouse just about suits your needs—especially if you're looking to shell out the minimum possible cash.



Samsung SMP2100WX B+	
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Build quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Ergonomics	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶